

openSUSE development team, provide them funding so that they have resources to get their work done; provide content, engineers; and sometimes we rent space for them to hold their conferences. So we help the community to work together and to survive. That is totally collaboration based. So I do not have the power to tell the openSUSE community what they must work on. We are also working with the OpenStack community. We play an important role there as well. We are their platinum sponsors, so we finance the community to make sure that it works. One of our employees is the first chairman of the OpenStack board, not because we appointed him but because he was elected by the community. So there are many examples of us engaging, collaborating and contributing. But no one can force the community to do anything.

Q Half of the supercomputers in the world are running SUSE Linux. And there are many other distributions around, including some really good Linux ones. Why do you think the makers of the supercomputers choose SUSE over others?

Nils: I think it is proof of our ability to develop solutions for certain target markets, which is the enterprise customer. Maybe the enterprise customer has slightly different needs from the consumers or the developer community. They might not look for the newest and most attractive features around Linux but what they really need is reliability, stability and performance. That is what we are trying to work on. So we have a reputation, expertise and quality in our Linux distribution. We set up our kernel to deliver those results for high-performance tasks. Apart from that, since years we have had a good relationship with hardware vendors. They do performance testing and they realise that we are really fast and they can rely on us.

Q You just mentioned your OEM partners. If you look at Canonical, it is joining hands with hardware players to popularise Ubuntu and is making an effort to increase its retail presence. What is SUSE's strategy in the desktop space? Why are you not joining hands with OEM partners to make SUSE popular in the desktop space as well?

Nils: I am glad Canonical is making such an effort. Let us not forget that Ubuntu is also living off the same kernel and by virtue of this, we are all members of the same open source Linux community and we all contribute to it. These are the things we have in common but there are a host of things that separate us. From a very early point of time, we have clarified that our sweet spot is the enterprise customer, where we offer Linux enterprise servers and Linux enterprise desktops. We want to be the Linux distribution that is best for enterprise customers. We believe that our system is most stable and best performing, and that we are probably one of the most interoperable solutions in the Linux environment. That also means that we are not as innovative about Linux when it comes down to the community and in offering new features for the



Venkatesh Swaminathan, country manager, The Attachmate Group (India)

"I think open source communities are appreciative of good technology work done in all the domains. We definitely keep a watch on the products, but I wouldn't comment on whether Windows 8 will inspire us in the development of upcoming versions."

community. Ubuntu has certain strengths in the desktop space and they are working more with the consumer market. Needless to say, this is the reason why the majority of their successes are around the desktops. SUSE has tie-ups with enterprise vendors like HP, Huawei and many others who pre-load SUSE with their enterprise products.

Q How much of a role does SUSE have to play in bringing out openSUSE?

Nils: There is a set of engineers that works for and is paid for by SUSE but also works for openSUSE projects in its